LESSON 5

Jingle Bells
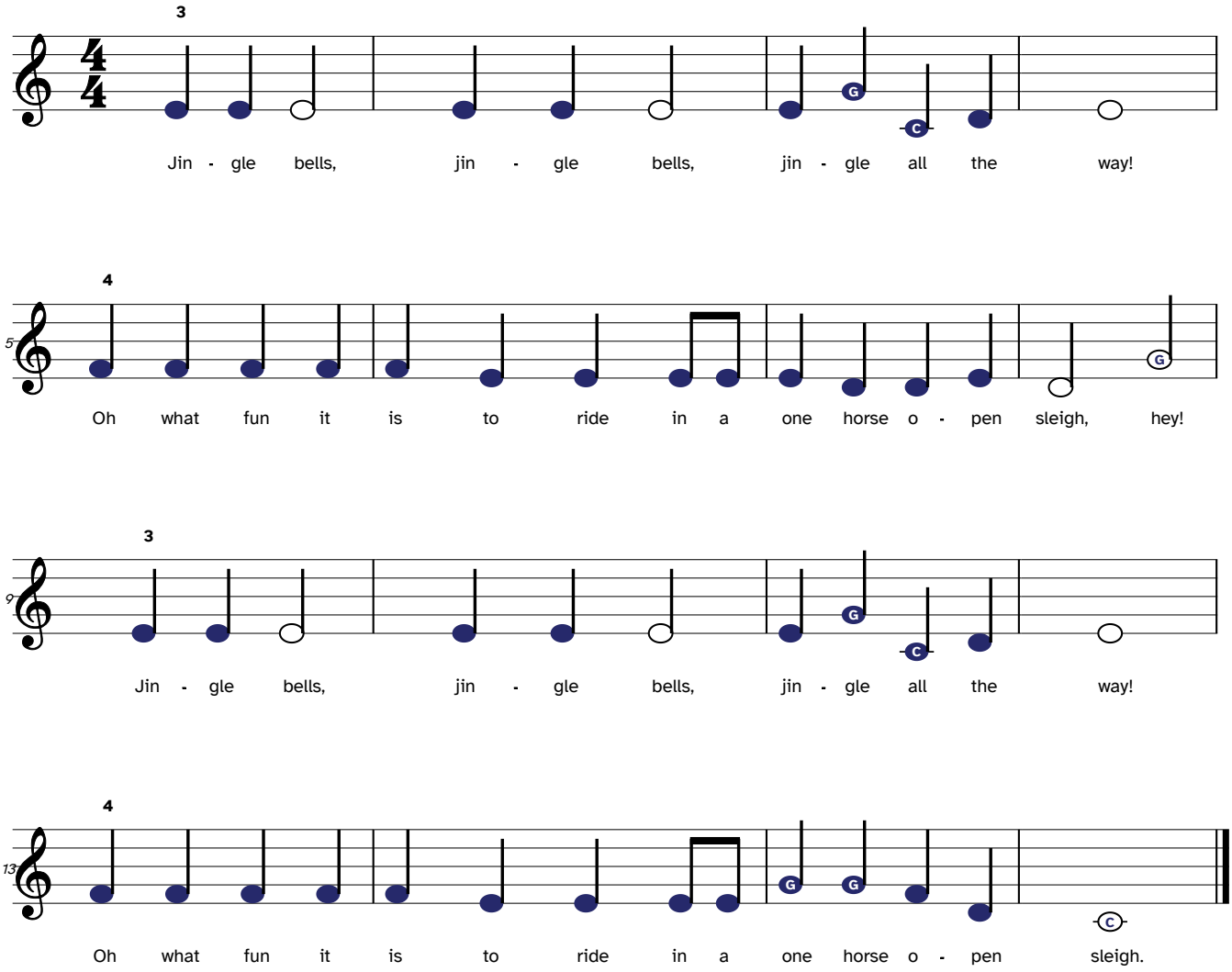
By James Lord Pierpont, published in 1857: a song for a winter sleigh ride.

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen once, then hum along.

THE WOW MOMENT
Sleigh ride with the band: scan the code and play the chorus with real bells.

1 Meet the song

Only C and G keep their letters now: find the others from them. Listen, point, then sing.



- [ ] Listened and pointed
- [ ] Sang it with the words

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

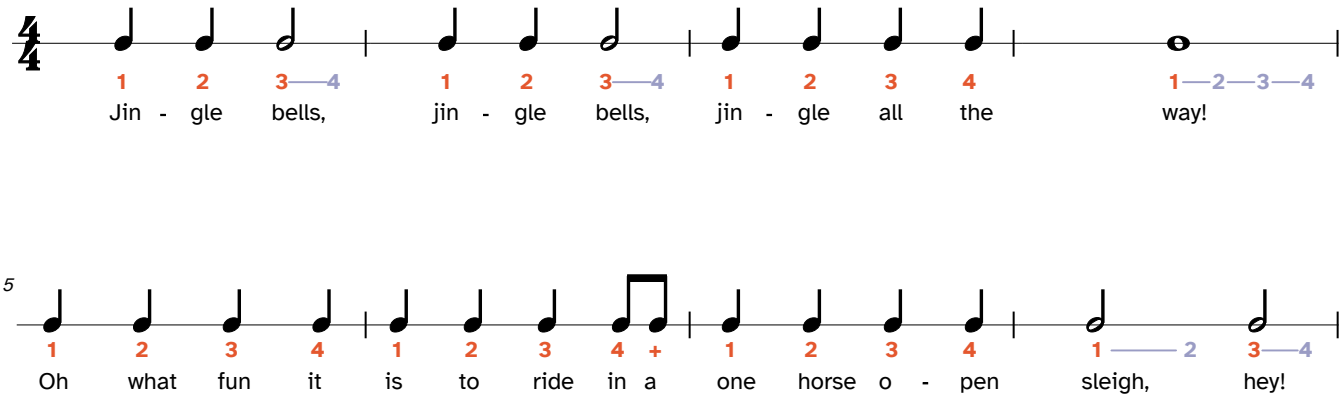
THE NOTES

crotchet: walk — 1 beat ●

two quavers: run-ning — 1 beat ◖◗

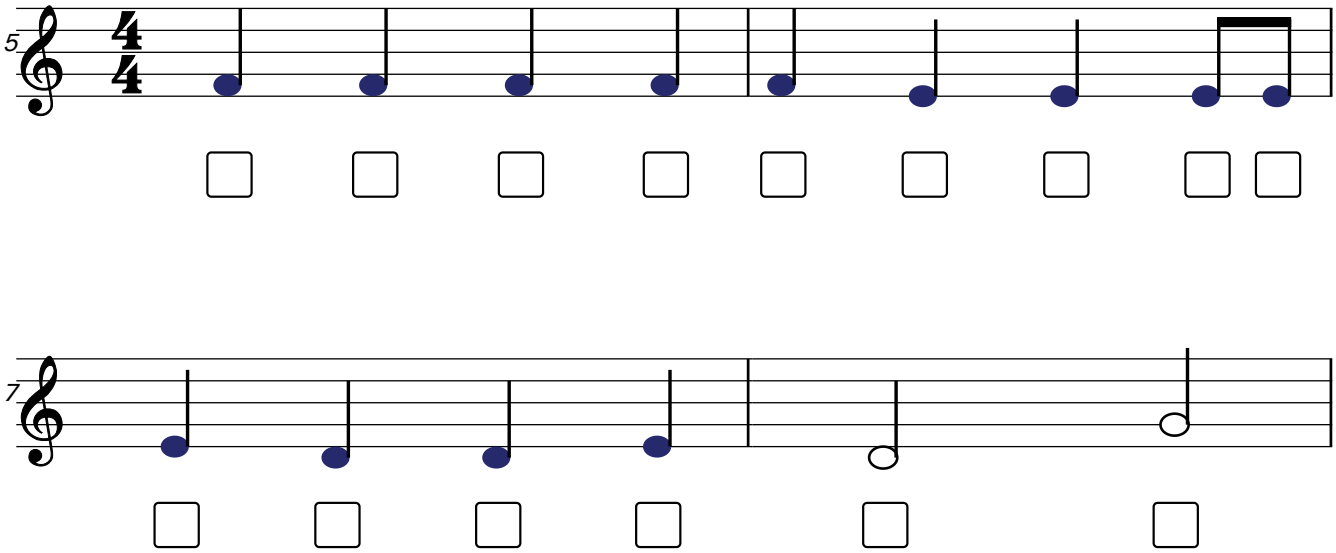
minim: hold — 2 beats ●●

semibreve: hold-2-3-4 — 4 beats ●●●●



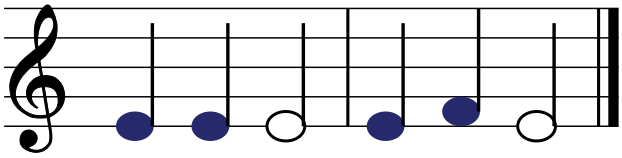
THE NOTES

Only C and G are named in the song now. Write the letter under each note of these bars.



SPOT THE MISTAKE

One note here is wrong. Play it, then the same bars on page 1: which note sounds wrong? Circle it.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**
- [ ] **Spotted the mistake**

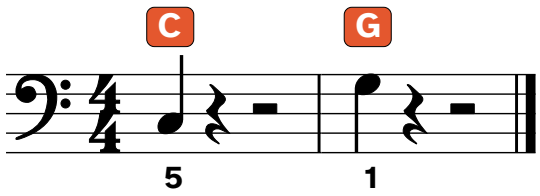
3 Lead sheet

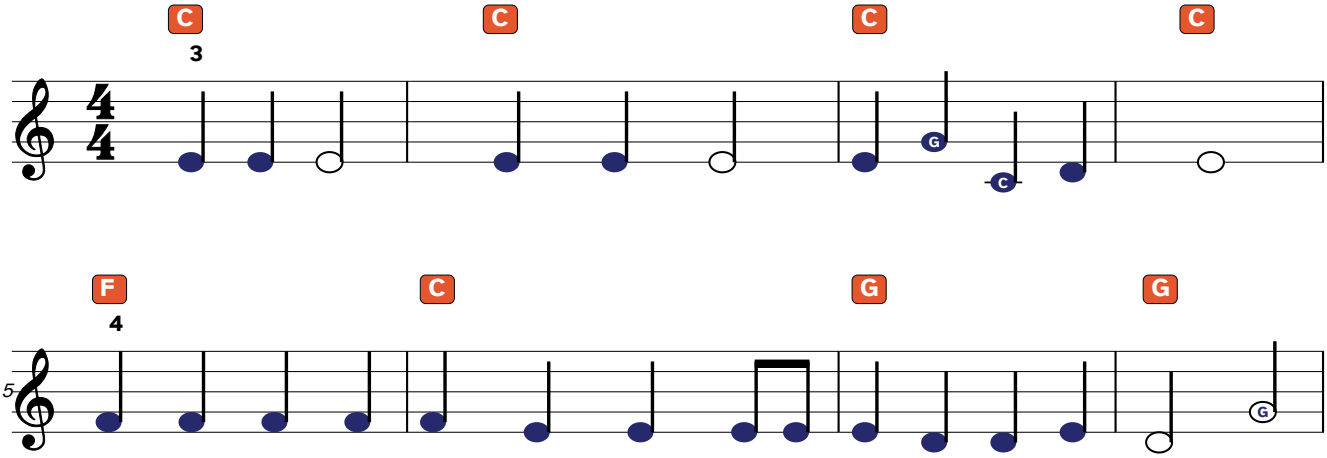
The tune and its chord names. A new name: F. The left hand taps each root on beat 1: C, F or G.

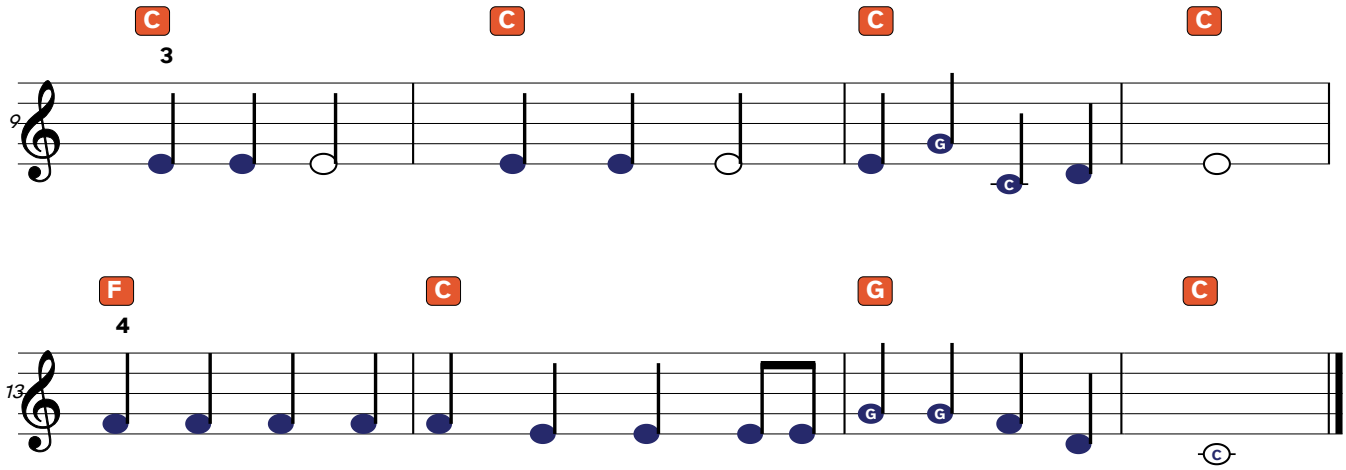
TAP THE ROOT

The root is the chord's own letter: C for C, G for G. Play it once, on beat 1, and let it ring.

C F G







1 Tune alone, right hand

2 Left hand alone: tap the roots while the recording plays the tune

3 Together, slowly

4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words

☐ I can find C and G and count from them

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
The tune				
With the roots				

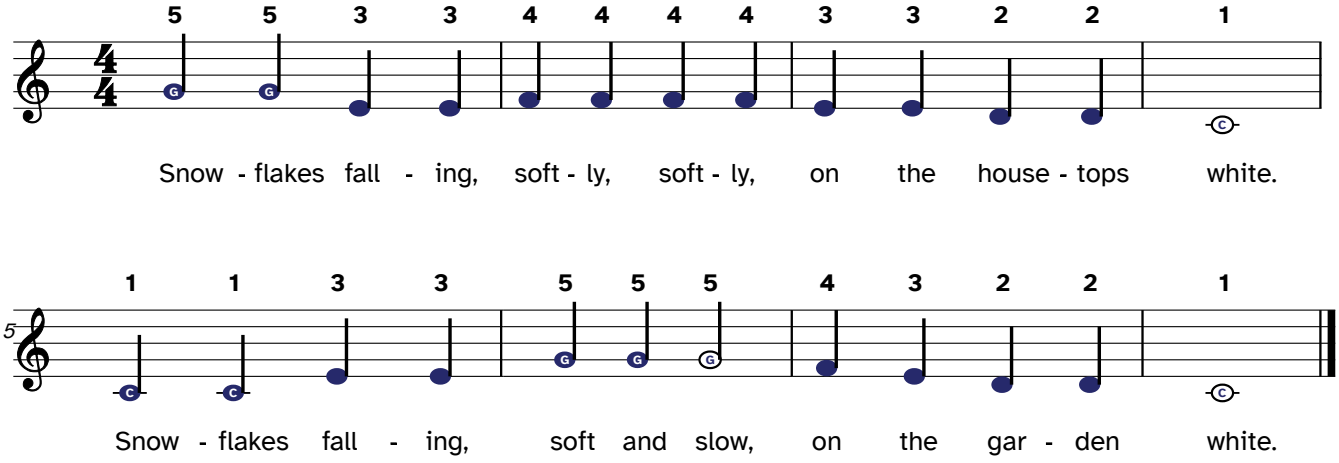
LISTEN BACK ☐ I recorded it ☐ It sounded right

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

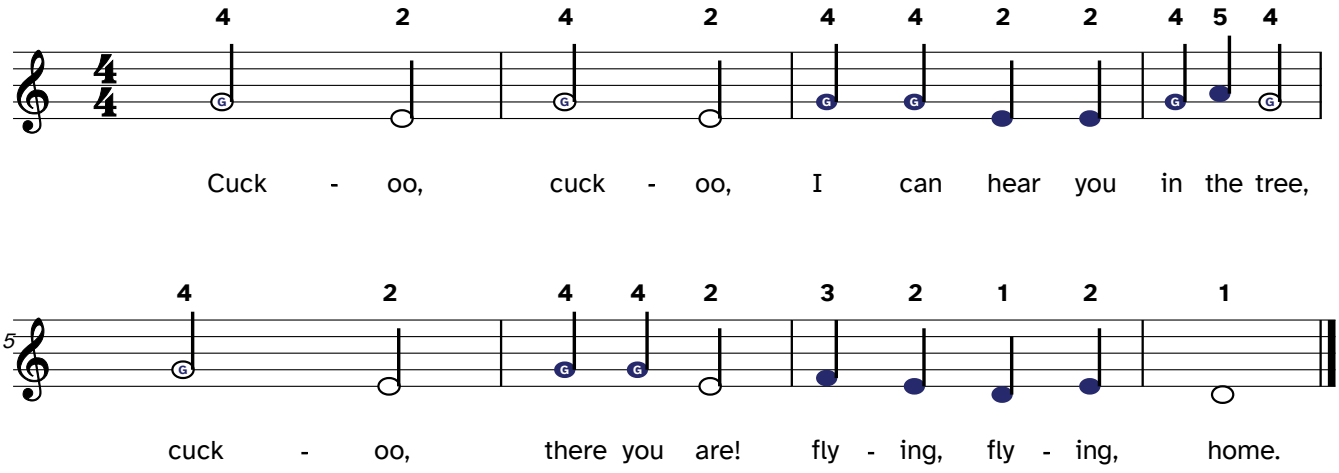
SNOWFLAKES

Soft and slow, like snow: notes that come again, and a long one to hold at the end of each line.



CUCKOO

A peek at Lesson 6: the cuckoo's call, G and E, with fingers 4 and 2. The hand sits one key higher, thumb on D, so finger 5 plays A.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Record it on a phone and listen back: does it sound the way you meant?

- ☐ **Galloping: quick and light, like the horse**
- ☐ **Heartbeat: the left hand taps low C on beat 1 of every bar**
- ☐ **Snowy: slow and soft, like falling snow**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. The whole song, twice
3. Left hand: tap the roots (page 3)
4. Play it with the band

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played the first tune** ☐ **Played the second tune**